renj

all faith
that there is

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foreword

there is a specific kind of exhaustion that comes from holding things together with nothing but repetition. these are the entries written when the machinery stopped humming, left out in the open where the weather could get to them.

nothing here is sacred on purpose. it's just what remained when the rooms emptied out and the light changed color, forcing us to look at the convents we built our grief inside of.

take whatever pieces still have life, leave the rest locked behind the glass.

reny

RENJ

when he was gone

The trees will dislike it if you take the canopy,
Their breath too precious, you're in entropy.
The glitters all end up on your soft palms now,
Inside is just a third bottle of the same perfume.
The pictures on the walls will smile louder,
Their veneers fleeing as you grow the feeder.
You crave for all the untamed creatures,
Who then understands his own nature.

You trade places from where you belong,
Looking for a house on the long way home,
You never imagined, getting better at being alone.
You crave for more but wake up stuffed on the bus,
And you realize he was never as he was,
Always looked better, always looked younger,
Then he was gone.

You keep giving the balcony, pieces of your mind.
Their faces will fare strongly against your rewind.
The air will arrest the complications in your head,
And all you'll ever ask for is more instead.
Your lawn will always look worse than your neighbor's
And you'll use nail cutters to prune the worst.
Their afterthoughts are just your worst nightmares,
Then you'll understand what's left to be here.

You'll run away from where you were from,
Running in a dress like it was a 1800s prom.
Always looked better, dressed in sweaters from the mall.
Calling him over if he could turn his car on,
He's dancing with her, you're in heels fleeing headlong,
You never imagined, he would be over you,
When he was gone.

You'll ask about what he did to leave it a secret,
When your departure tore him apart in repeat.
He used to be an ice that you could melt,
Now you ask for his presence, long day, you knelt.
Your castle's all a nightmare, when he was to leave,
You said he would never feel better and would not live.
She's dancing with him on the dancefloor,
Now you're in his backseat asking him like you did before.

And he had put his headphones on,
Running through the city with his bride from then on.
She indeed looked better, dressed in a white silk gown.
You come over the window and you're in a taxi,
Watching over the city when you left, you're in scarcity,
You never imagined, everything could be over,
When it was gone.

a thousand times

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Most nights I think about you,
On my sheets as the notes build up.
Where are you? What would you do?

Sometimes, it's more of a walk away,
On my screen as the lights come up.
What are you? What do you do?

But something in the silence fills it,
The thickest frail men sing on it.
I would swear that it was true,
Too far on the right, falls on my due.
How do I know if you feel the same?
I wouldn't, more than a thousand times.

Most nights I regroup the screws,
On my bed as I lay on the sharp edges.
Do you feel it too? The bitter crew?

Sometimes, it's more of a slave away,
On my clock as the tick closes the drapes.
When it comes, where would you be?

But something in the quiet shouts it,
More than what I think is true about it.
My friends all tell me that I'm true,
Too far on my left, it recalls anew,
How do I know you feel the same?
I think I should know, a thousand times.

Most nights, love feels all too same,
On what I know and what could be taught.
Who are you? Do you know my name?

Sometimes, I think it's more of a stray,
On the worst giving me the best.
Do I know of you? Does it come as it may?

But something in me has felt it,
Something screams that I know the answer to it.
My hands all say that all of it's true.
Too far high, it refuses to be construed.
How do I know you feel the same?
It's all right, just do it a thousand times.

RENJ

sugar highing

Let the seal on the envelope get warmed,
And all the parchment to seal the floor.
In the age of instant rise,
You kept postmen on their lines.
And the thrill of it was sure good,
I would've never left it if I could.

But I keep shaking on my promises,
Like the earthquake that rolled a hiss.

'Cause I was sugar highing through the hill,
Scouring words to match your mystique powers.
Sipping on my drink until I took my fill,
Months later, I feel you while sleepwalking.
I think I almost let you down, so I'll keep walking.

Let the drinks bubble up dry,
You kissed me and I wished to die.
In the age I turned nineteen,
And you were feeling like a tween.
And the roses on my cheeks were sure good,
I would've never erased them if I could.

But my nerves are our promises,
All for the kid and her hopeful bliss.

'Cause I was pure sugar highing like on a pill,
Stumbling words praying this all could recover.
I crave for nothing, then take everything,
Sleepwalking until I can deafen myself out from crying.
I think I almost left your town, so I'll keep walking.

They say distance is one of the worst reasons,
So I kept the most awful in my discretion.
Because I almost left myself as a good person.
So I made you reasons not to believe it,
But me saying all this proves that you're right in it,
So I'll keep leaning, until you could miss me.

'Cause I was sugar highing from the nick of it,
Rockclimbing until I take my breath saying nothing.
I touch and go to make me an arrow hit,
Month on, I still wonder if I was sleepwalking through it.
I think you were almost out my town, so keep walking.

RENJ

the tip of mine

A splendid morning on a troubled night,
Four shoelaces caught in a single fight.
In the bed, you would feel the sheets,
The crumpled words against illicit defeat.

She calls me mine, been a wonderful time.
A criminal, then the imperfect crime.
Into the woods, and her truce,
My trysts elevated to be deduced.

You would only see, the tip of mine,
When every blister of lust pops on the mind.

Aggregated rooms over torrential nights,
In crystal robes in the darkest sights.
Under the bed, where the skeletons rise,
And on my neck, lips lead to my demise.

You call me hers, but it's a wandering time;
I keep my headlights on to see the crime.
Into the yard, when the separates collide,
Three caskets in, and just a single bride.

You could only see the tip of mine,
I loved the way she said goodbye.

RENJ

windows are a question

It was creaking all the time,
Was it just the sun on the horizon.
When every door is change of mind,
And the windows are a question.

The rush wraps the vanity,
And mine is a memory.

Red lines give lovers' reach,
While the sand grovels the beach.
It holds some kind of release,
'Cause love was always grieving.

Woven cloth over rugged tile,
The machines speed until discretion.
Silent resentment is futile,
So we got no words on our creation.

The mahogany in the vanity,
And yours is a black day.

Two hands yield the same reach,
And the eyes are just a leech.
It could have been everything,
But love was always grieving.

when you woke up

RENJ

Did you hear him when you woke up?
When my favorite record ripped the room?
Did you try to cover your ears?
Or did you bask on your fatalistic years?

I know I want his cold bottles of frizzles,
Things you despise but still love anyway.
Did your eyes pass through the crystals,
Did the light burn your retina,
'Cause if it did then I'd be a pal.

I know it could rest easier if the dead were silenced,
But it would be assumptive now that we look balanced.

Did you hear him through my choice of words?
Did forgetting him make me your outwards?
Did you ration with your holograms?
Do I look too much like his anagram?
Was he in his circular eye frames?
While you loop your hands around my lens?
Did your fingers feel his hands,
When you put the anklet on me,
'Cause if it did why am I not appalled?

I know it could be harder if I pressed on too much,
But it would be assumptive if I didn't ask about his touch.

Because most nights, I feel I should compete,
Against the walls of your long-haunted defeat.
And the loneliest go for their routine sleep,
But in the morning they do mental leaps.

I know it would be lighter if I weighed myself down,
But it would be assumptive if I just wore his crown.

Did the needle pierce through hard on the quiet,
Did the moth flap its wing to burn the candle bright?
Answer for responses will never be enough,
Did you hear him when you woke up?

RENJ

on the long way

Tell me everything up for changing,
I'll tell you about the peculiar case of ours.
I should treat you to a thousand roses,
To show that I'm pricked by your voices.

You will feel torn in the hollow,
The dream you have is just an open row.
Try to look for yourself on the long way,
I hope it gives you everything I can't give away.

You tell me that we will give in someday,
When all of your demons take your way.
I should give you your thousand voice notes,
To show that I'm all too deaf to your hoax.

You find safety in the deranged,
The dream to follow is just you rearranged.
Then go try to look for yourself on the long way,
I wish it gives you your so-called better days.

You will spend your whole life looking,
And I will spend my days over my summer booking.
I shouldn't give you this little voice note,
But I have to tell you some sort of farewell note.

You will always feel too shallow,
The dream you look for is just your show.
Go on try to look for yourself on the long way,
I hope it kisses you better than I could ever, in any way.

RENJ

over last night

You throw me your phone, I take off my case,
Been the sixth night in a row, it's better in the days.
You scream through your mother's eyes,
I cry through your father's nose.
It is what it is until it becomes too predictable.

All the affirmations and complications were said,
You will make a truce, and I would call it just right.
Called it off the night before again,
Because it was almost over last night.

So I risk pulling the plug, I try to strike a nerve,
You go on to pack your bags, you stay for the eve.
I look into your phone, find the places I've known,
Your bag is a pillow through the night,
It is what it is until it becomes too predictable.

All the goodbyes and the threat of a foot out the door,
You would call amends, and it would be just right.
Called your flight off the night before again,
Because it was almost over last night.

You say your home is leaving out the door,
I put my shoe out in the grass, I really do know.
Some more nights until the promised forever,
Will spin through this night and get ready for the other.
It is what it is until it becomes too predictable.

All the apologies and confessions were said,
We'd have a prayer and things go double dead.
Called off my ride in the middle of the fight
Because it was almost over last night.

hour of gloom

RENJ

Don't bother zipping the suitcases,
One day, one moment, let it all out.
The clothes, the foam, and the satin.
Where it leads, the heads and the places.

The hard case is just temporary,
But now the bluest sky has an honorary,
And maybe, it was always momentary.

It's the hour of gloom until it's gone.
But it will never be, once it has begun.
Always and forever, they say,
But when I do, I come not to play.
But maybe this is all amusing,
The hour of gloom's darkest musing.

Talk of an avalanche like I've seen snow,
We get knowledgeable on what we don't know.
When everything's in between, yet nothing's on,
The streets are clients I could never con.

The hard case is more than memory,
It fulfills itself like some kind of prophecy,
Because maybe its form was just momentary.

It's the hour of gloom but it's never gone.
I piece my dues until the receipts are on.
Always and forever, I will always say,
And in dusted demeanor, I'll spend my days.
But maybe this is my fleeting torment,
Or maybe the hour of gloom's amazement.

The hour is between the screen and my hands,
The tip of my tongue, the edge of my seat.
The hour is the bitter in everything sweet,
Pulling me over when I push them in retreat.
The hour is a reminder when to forget,
The partial fulfillment in every regret.

It's the hour of gloom until it's not,
But the pleas of the entertained are not enough.
Always and forever, will the hour stay.
I mourn this day until I can betray.
But maybe this is my defacement,
Or just the hour of gloom's commitment.

RENJ

wreck's onset

The seeds came into the shed overwet,
When the water came in and rotted the wood.
The timber was pruned from the inside,
Grew purple flowers in the wreck's onset.

Hold the vines as the roots grew loud,
And the sky wrapped dark on a perfect mound.
The greens kept growing down the neck,
It would have been beautiful if it wasn't fake.
And then came the golden morning,
Gone would be the rays of it, all for fathoming.

The winter came and breath was the overcast,
When the water turned to ice I couldn't feel anymore,
So I poked my eyes against the walls until I could see no more,
The purple neck grew on recast.

Helped the vines grip on my thighs,
So I slipped out of my perfect sighs.
The greens kept rotting down the timber gaps,
Blotting out names until they're just flaps.
And then came the golden spring morning,
Gone was the etch of the vines, I think I'm fathoming.

Two months older, more can give in.
Just because it died, doesn't mean there are no seeds to leave in.
Three months bolder, I still believe.
Just because it died, the promises can't still live.

The seeds came into the shed overwet,
When the water came in and rotted the wood.
The morning came crashing down my golden eyes,
With the roof and I can see the same-colored skies.
And when the rain came pouring,
Rushed was the overgrowth, I am fathoming.

RENJ

far off

I fought sturdy doors when I climbed on your lift,
Drove on my right while I went to your left,
The roads cough up and they feel all too wet.
My car was giving up on the thrill of the night,
The backseat was moaning, waiting for yellow lights,
I stopped asking now if you would ride it for free.

So tell me, how much more of innocence,
Can you take away from my rotten fence.
It had been far off to ask, find one more than once.

I keep creating hours and put minutes on the board,
Ride on the steering wheel like I should be bored,
It felt too eventful that I didn't like to record.
Too much of it was just words taken on a spin,
Screenplays and reverbs you all take for akin,
I stopped asking now until cons start reeking.

So tell me, how many false promised lands
Can you take away until the realtors glance.
You are too far off, long gone in the long dance.

And you kept saying I called to abandon the ship,
But I was in a car, rotting through the apprenticeship.
Holding on to your suppositions instead of your lips.
I'll come for merry nights and ask to play with the lights,
You'll be standing on the other line through the night,
And I was a rotting tree, the star had long been upright.

So tell me, how many more nights can we
Take control until we realize that we're not.
It's far off and far done, all good, all gone.

crescent noon

RENJ

On the plane, it crossed my mind,
Is human nature all built to survive?
When the dust bit your cheeks on the ride,
I was still on your side.
Beautiful flowers, heavenly abode,
Is human nature all built to survive,
When your shoelaces all expired,
They were still on your underside.

Pulling me in like a crescent noon,
Excitement of seeing you soon.
Deep six hours and feel together,
I feel like the idea of forever.
By your side, over the crescent noon.

Jubilations, all spoken to the fire,
As the ashes push up daisies,
The gardener took as he pleased,
I was still on your side.
They can't remember, I won't fathom,
When you're resting on my mind,
Gone west on the side behind,
You were still on my side.

Heating me up like the crescent noon,
Feeling half when more of it's gone.
Withered away and blown together,
What is love if it's not all-forever?
By your side, under the crescent noon.

Because your absence speaks of niceness,
Nature has taken its debt,
Became one with the longest breath,
They'll be on your side.
Because it gives me peace of mind,
A piece of land to grow old,
Forever young and feeling held.
You'll be always by my side.

Pulling air under the crescent noon,
Filling up the oceans including the moon.
I cry a spring, you leave in a ship,
What is life if it's not about our relationship?
By my side, during the crescent noon.

RENJ

shake my head

Hold my face, move those fingers, baby.
I've been making my voice yours.
Say my name, move those lips, baby.
I've been making them yours.

How would I know how this will go?
How could I know if this is true?
I just want you to hold me, false and true.

Shake my head, move those legs to me.
I've been wanting you to move.
Put your fingers down, move them down to me,
I've wanted those tights removed.

How would they know how far this goes?
How would they know it's not their overdose?
I just want to know you, down and aroused.

Move my bed, put my city beside yours.
I've been wanting this for you.
Move your body, put mine between yours,
I've been reserved all for you.

How would they know where this goes?
How do I know how far we'll go?
I just want you to know me, from and to.

Keep me awake, I have what you have,
I've been wronged by mine too.
Keep me on damnation, hell for us to save,
I've been enjoying our time too.

Now that I know how deep this could go,
How could they know what we do?
I only want yours to be with mine, red and blue.

hands on the clocks

RENJ

Two small hands on the clock, I lay on the beach,
Some more hours still have to go.
Your hair all braided with my tribulations,
Screaming you don't have to put on a show.

Your clothes are all wet, and my eyes are all red
Screaming under the clear seagull day.
I come to say my goodbye, it will all be just fine,
Some seeds take root but they do grow.

The chauffeur called my name as I looked back,
Because he sounded too much like your voice.
And I'm going down the mirror on the back,
Go with the plane and make the predestined choice.

How is it too tight now when all I ever asked was,
To be held by your hands through the night.
Somehow you feel like a stranger, I ask what I was,
And it deferred what I wanted to remain upright.

I found myself into distractions, was I yours?
Did the glint of my eyes drizzle as warning signs?
My face has been denied, I'm on my fours,
Something cannot be done while it resigns.

I have come to learn of a power from what you said,
When all my bones sat over the moon.
I'm with the sky, my destiny is all denied,
Something outgrew me while it died, too soon.

RENJ

a last time and fast times

I'll ask of what has changed between pages,
The reckless wanting of being yours would suffice,
The bitterness that wants to leak from my eyes.
Crying feels too weak for someone as frail as me,
And my freedom is much more suffocating than free.

Did the choice of being mine double-cross me?
Everything I blamed you for, the treason I called out,
Seems to be self-blame told in the second person.
You should have known how much harder I tried
To get bitter over you than to be bitter about what we had.

I have taken the time to think of it on the bed.
There will be eyes that are too good to leave behind,
But those same pairs are far worse to get behind.
I may have been over the spontaneous springs,
Yet I still ask the wind to blow me engagement rings.

The pedestal of being the one that got away,
I admit it is too intoxicating to withdraw what I posit.
When all comfort I could have is this seat.
They say complexity doesn't come from intelligence
But does it come with understanding indifference?

I have put in the work to move the days after,
The other ones will cramp their ways into my chair,
Taking them in as I function over the thinnest air.
Running as fast as I can, quicker and louder,
Faster and quieter, when the haunted is the haunter.

Did the choice of running for myself destroy me?
When everything I ever was put on the line,
And in self preservation, came damage and decline.
To have bragged about independence to their face,
In private, in longing, to be decimated and defaced.

Does going over mean going under my heart?
Can I trust my decision to have been right all along,
Does the inequality of destruction make me long
For the liberation I am starting to see as a mistake,
What kind of a last time and fast times did I forsake?

RENJ

carry on

The bees have all buzzed out now,
The pollen has all been scattered.
We lock eyes faithfully,
We feel so disparate now,
But not of inadequacy.

When the seas have receded low,
The roughest rocks are out for show.
Now we can leap from stone to stone
We could jump until we have atoned.
All bags on a shoulder gone,
So there's nothing to carry on.

'Cause the breaths somehow mattered,
And the voices deeply smothered,
No bloodbath to pool us in,
We feel so desperate now,
But not of inadequacy.

Naturally, to this path we have been led,
I'll drive to the right, you'll choose the left.
But we don't fear our ways this time,
And on our way, we feel the sky.
All forsaken choices are withdrawn,
So we have nothing to carry on.

My fellow child of the bloom,
Our tears have receded into flumes.
The windshields long gone and we're anew,
The field's all green now and dewed,
No more rings now, we are renewed.
So carry on.

RENJ

it's all pure faith

Looking at you from the Highlands,
Their stools rise too far above the ground.
Their coffee not all too dark now,
The bitterness is just as strong as it was.

It was too much of a horizon to long for,
To be paralyzed and settle my own score.
To freefall in the faith of being younger,
Now in the ashes of getting old I will linger.

Just because life can be too undecided on you,
Doesn't have to mean you should be on me too.
Will start on counting my pulses when I'm out,
Not to fear away from gravity's roundabout.

Calling the day over from Ground Zero,
Now that bar is for new generations and heroes.
Another pair of young necks will discover,
They would think it would be eternal to recover.

It's too much of a banquet to get a hangover,
And the hotels will lead the self to recant.
The windows will feel too high above the ground,
And they'll wind down the thoughts abound.

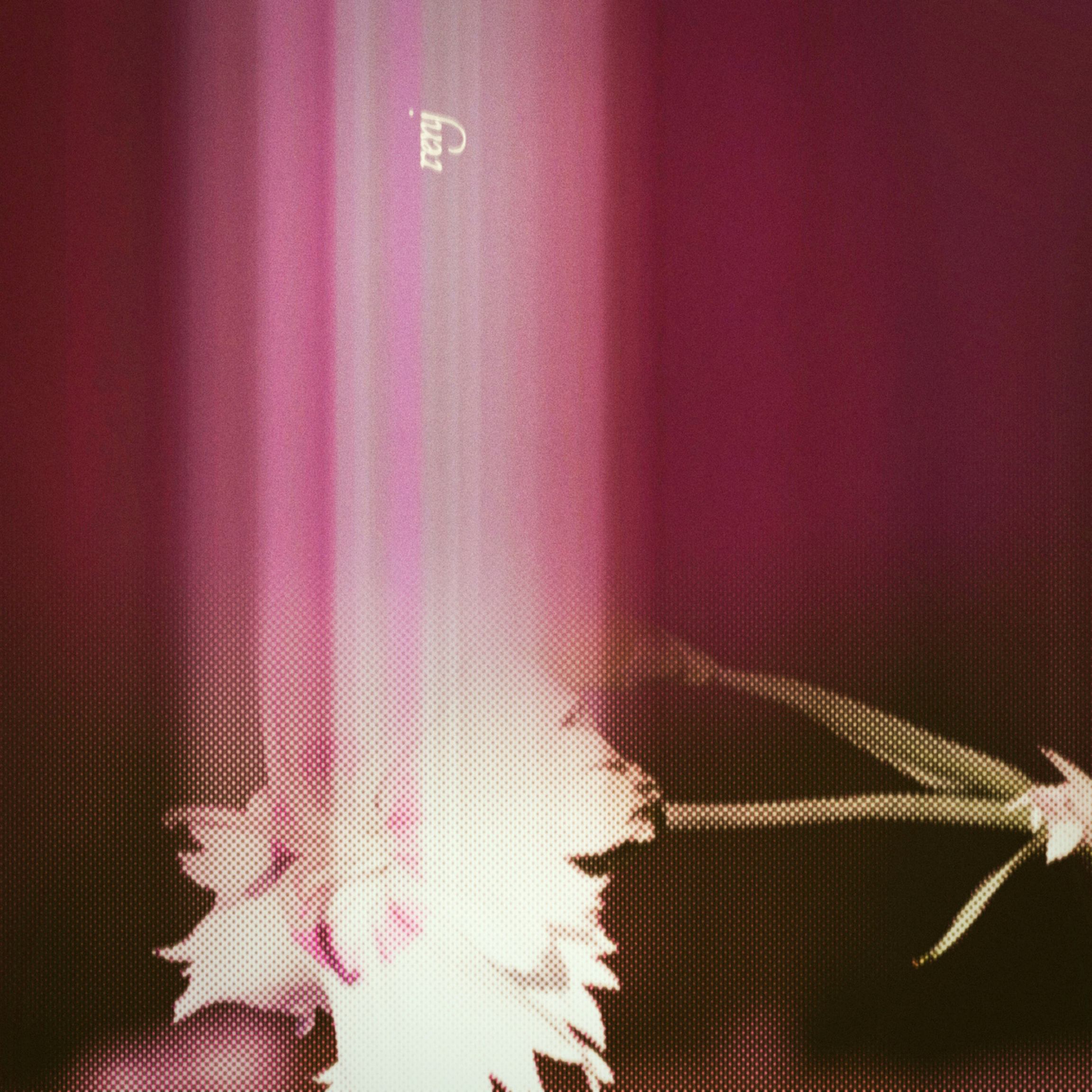
Just because the impositions have been answered,
Doesn't have to mean what you have is devoured.
Will the questions ever die down, you ask,
No dear, they will be louder when you bask.

The day's all set as I lay down on the Terraces,
The moon is gold and you will know my trances.
Some courage has to break through to uncover
That you're still the same person that's a lover.

You will see it wind down as pure faith lingers,
And in the process, you are to trust it is preserved.
You will be tired of having a far way long ahead,
But you're going to need someone to tread with.

To fall freely into someone else's arms,
Is to rejoice in yours and never decry its warmth.
Trust me, pure faith is all I can muster,
And it's the best freedom I came to master.

ray.



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all faith that there is

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